

3 Day Basic Beginner Routine

Simple barbell training to get started

Alternate Workout A and B, 3 days per week, with a rest day between lifting days. Each lift is 3 sets of 5 reps — the "+" means your last set is as many good reps as you can manage. Stop when form breaks down or the bar slows.

Workout A

- Barbell Row — 3 x 5+
- Bench Press — 3 x 5+
- Squat — 3 x 5+

Workout B

- Chin-ups (or equivalent) — 3 x 5+
- Overhead Press — 3 x 5+
- Deadlift — 3 x 5+

Schedule

- Mon A · Wed B · Fri A, then rotate B · A · B.
- Do all sets of one lift, then move to the next.
- Rest 2–3 minutes between sets.

Progression

- Upper body: add 2.5 lb / 1.25 kg each session.
- Lower body: add 5 lb / 2.5 kg each session.
- If you get 10+ reps on the last set, add double the usual increment.
- If you fail to hit 15 total reps, deload 10% next time.

Cardio (2 days per week)

- One easy day — walk, jog, light cycling (15–30 min).
- One hard day — intervals or circuits (10–15 min).
- Do cardio after lifting if on the same day.

How Long?

Run for up to 3 months, then move to a more comprehensive program like GZCLP.

Weight Log